

As I said, I do not know how to measure this, but all I can say is that the number of platforms is growing and so are the ecosystems attached to those platforms. So, obviously, there is a need for people to participate in the growth process.

Q Are your clients comfortable with open source solutions?

Our direct business comes from customers who pick

up processor platforms and develop products around those platforms. These include HP, Dell, Lenovo and many others. They are not consuming our applications. It is their customers, including the enterprises and the SMEs across the country, who

are the consumers of our applications. Having said that, I would like to draw your attention to several analysts' reports confirming that usage of open source applications is growing. We can safely say that the consumption of open source technology has increased amongst one and all. It may not be very visible but it has definitely gone up in a major way.

Q Do you think FOSS platforms or tools score over their proprietary counterparts in the current scenario, particularly for enterprises and SMEs?

For IT managers, the debate is not about FOSS or proprietary technology. They look for the best solution. I don't think they start the conversation by saying that I am going to use FOSS so let me figure out what business solution I will focus on. They focus on the best solution. In the current scenario, it is pretty apparent that there are hybrid solutions in the market. I don't think one drives the other. There's a lot of good co-operation as far as the deployment in large enterprises is concerned. So, as I said before, I can say that FOSS tools are being preferred and there is a definite under current about FOSS technologies. I cannot give you figures to support that statement but I can surely say that things have moved to the hybrid stage from pure proprietary offerings. That in itself is one of the biggest testimonials of a FOSS victory.

Q Do FOSS platforms add value to project development?

If you look at the FOSS tools being downloaded, one can clearly say that these are increasing with every passing day. If so, it speaks volumes about the fact that people are getting comfortable with open source technologies. Fundamentally, the makers of the platform will also focus on monetising the platforms. I am one person who is more involved with evangelising among developers, so if you ask this question to the practitioners, you will get the exact answer. But if you broaden the question, I can say that developers do benefit from the tools available openly to them. Which is why, they are increasingly using open

source technology in project development.

Q What kind of talent do you look for when it comes to hiring for Intel?

I think we look for a complete package when we hire a developer. We look for various aspects including knowledge of software, knowledge of hardware, knowledge of the ecosystem, an understanding of how a particular software can work with a piece of hardware, how the driver interoperates with various other drivers in the system, et al. In today's scenario, we definitely recommend that developers build their skills, particularly in terms of how the devices are becoming aware of the environment. For example, many

of the devices in the market have a slew of sensors. We strongly recommend that developers start looking at them to understand how they interoperate. That is the most pervasive aspect that determines how the mechanism interacts with the ecosystem.

The ideal skills that we want developers to build on are related to power—how to deliver performance and not consume excessive power. So if someone is building a solution for an ultrabook, a phone or even a high-performance computing server that will run millions of calculations every second, we encourage developers to start thinking about how to write code efficiently to improve the performance. In some way or the other way, everyone expects their device, PC or ultrabook to be responsive. Developers should know how to make their applications responsive enough so that they impress the ultimate consumers.

Q So do you get that kind of talent in the Indian colleges and universities? Do you see the colleges adapting to such technological changes to ensure their students are employable in companies like Intel?

I can say that over a period of time, the curriculum has improved broadly, but I still feel that we could improve a lot faster. Having said that, let me tell you that there are some colleges working aggressively to adapt their curriculum, keeping in mind the needs of the industry.

Q Once the employees, particularly freshers, come on board, do you train them internally to get a flair for your technologies?

Yes, we have to—there are a number of things that we need to train them on in terms of our processes, our tool chain and our methodology, in order to make them perform efficiently in our environments. The training period could vary from a couple of weeks to a couple of months. The new recruits are provided with mentors internally and get time with experts. 

"The ideal skills that we want developers to build on are related to power—how to deliver performance and not consume excessive power."

—Narendra Bhandari, director,
Intel Software and Services Group, Intel South Asia